

Chicago Tribune



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BREAKING NEWS AT CHICAGOTRIBUNE.COM

Report: Uptick in CPD use of force

Video from body-worn cameras becoming an important training tool

By Sam Charles
Chicago Tribune

The woman stood on the sidewalk outside her home and waited for the first officers to show up. Blood streamed down her face and shoulders.

She had called 911 after her significant other stabbed her.

When officers arrived at the home in the Back of the Yards in July 2022, she pointed to the open doorway. Standing about 10 feet from the threshold, a man kept his grip on a knife in his right hand.

“Shoot me,” the man barked at the officers, as he took small, deliberate steps forward.

“Please drop the knife,” an officer, also on the sidewalk, yelled back. “I’m begging you. Drop the knife.”

As the man’s darkened silhouette continued forward, two red dots appeared: one on his chest, another on his thigh.

“Shoot me!” he demanded.

A moment later, a Taser was fired. A direct hit, splitting the man’s beltline. He fell backward, collapsing on the floor. An officer put down his Taser and put the man in handcuffs. One of the electrodes remained lodged in his shirt.

It was the type of deadly force encounter that’s routine for Chicago Police Department patrol officers in the city’s rougher neighborhoods. While

Turn to Force, Page 4

State clean energy gets hit hard by Trump bill

By Nara Schoenberg
Chicago Tribune

Already the calls are coming in at Chicago’s All Bright Solar.

Customers want solar roofs installed on their homes — and they want them before a federal tax credit worth about \$8,000 expires at the end of the year.

The repeal of that tax credit under President Donald Trump’s “One Big Beautiful Bill” is “pretty catastrophic” for residential solar, according to All Bright owner Lisa Albrecht, who expects demand to fall sharply.

“I’ve been on the ‘solar-coaster’ for a long time, and this is the roughest ride,” said Albrecht, using a term for the dramatic highs and lows of the industry. “I’m definitely white-knuckling it. (Illinois) will lose jobs. We will

Turn to Energy, Page 2



Former ComEd executive John Hooker speaks with his lawyer, Jackie Jacobson, as they leave the Dirksen U.S. Courthouse in Chicago on Monday. EILEEN T. MESLAR/CHICAGO TRIBUNE

Former ComEd lobbyist sentenced to 18 months

Hooker also fined for scheme to bribe ex-House Speaker Madigan

By Jason Meisner
Chicago Tribune

Former Commonwealth Edison lobbyist John Hooker was sentenced Monday to a year and a half in prison for his role in an elaborate scheme to funnel \$1.3 million to associates of then-House Speaker Michael Madigan in exchange for the powerful Democrat’s help with the utility’s legislative agenda in Springfield.

In imposing the 18-month sentence, U.S. District Judge Manish Shah told Hooker it was “imperative to wipe away the

notion” that his actions were merely the lobbying of a public official that had no real impact on average citizens.

“It is important for the punishment to reflect this was corruption of consequential public policy, involving far-reaching legislation and legislative functions,” said Shah, who also imposed a \$500,000 fine.

Echoing other federal judges who have ruled on corruption cases, Shah said that when sophisticated people like Hooker choose to bend the rules, it undermines the public’s faith in government

because “those without corrupt access are left voiceless, yet still under the thumb” of a dishonest system.

“It takes courage to speak up, to say ‘no’ in the face of power like Mr. Madigan’s,” Shah said. “It’s easy to say ‘yes’ when you have the talent and the wherewithal to play within the corrupt system.”

“You had the power to stop this,” Shah continued. “To do business with corrupt power encourages it.”

Shah also ruled that Hooker perjured himself repeatedly when testifying in his own defense at

trial, including when he told the jury he thought the subcontractors would be doing work and that he was just “joshing around” when he said in one wiretapped recording that they had to make the hires because Madigan asked.

Dressed in a dark suit, striped tie and black-framed eyeglasses, Hooker sat at the defense table and nodded slightly at the judge’s remarks. He showed no outward reaction to the sentence, though several relatives in the front row of the packed courtroom gallery

Turn to Sentenced, Page 4

President threatens Russia with more tariffs



President Donald Trump, right, greets NATO Secretary General Mark Rutte on Monday in the Oval Office. EVAN VUCCI/AP

Trump confirms weapons for Ukraine in bid to end conflict

By Chris Megerian and Illia Novikov
Associated Press

WASHINGTON — President Donald Trump threatened Russia with steep tariffs Monday and announced a rejuvenated pipeline for American weapons to reach Ukraine, hardening his stance toward Moscow after months of frustration about unsuccessful negotiations for ending the war.

The latest steps reflect an evolving approach from the Republi-

can president, who promised to swiftly resolve the war started by Russian President Vladimir Putin when he invaded Ukraine three years ago. Trump once focused his criticism on Ukrainian President Volodymyr Zelenskyy, whom he described as unwilling to compromise, but more recently has expressed growing irritation toward Putin.

“My conversations with him are very pleasant, and then the missiles go off at night,” Trump said. “It just keeps going on and on and on.”

Trump said he would implement “severe tariffs” unless a

Turn to Russia, Page 8

Speaker Welch endorses Stratton

Lt. Gov. Juliana Stratton added more endorsements in her campaign for the U.S. Senate seat being vacated by Sen. Dick Durbin. **Chicagoland, Page 3**

State Farm defends 27.2% rate hike

Bloomington-based State Farm said its Illinois homeowners business has seen “unsustainable” losses in 13 of the last 15 years. **Business**

What do the stars have in store?

Tribune columnist Rick Kogan writes that even as the number of newspapers has diminished, horoscopes remain a popular offering. **Arts & Living**

TODAY’S WEATHER



High 92 Low 74

Complete Chicagoland forecast on Page 14

\$4.00 city and suburbs and elsewhere
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